PMA CONTRACTS TEAM · NOVEMBER 2026

Billing 101: Team Reference

Danny and Dax onboarding

The review rule. Nothing goes to a PM or client until Sam has reviewed it. Questions go in the NetSuite (Contracts) chat, and blockers go on the Task Tracker.

In this packet

1. How you'll ramp up p. 1
2. What we'll cover p. 2
3. Billing basics p. 3
4. New project setup p. 4
5. Rules p. 4
6. How an invoice works p. 6
7. Monthly Invoicing Checklist p. 7
8. Sample invoices p. 10
9. Saved searches p. 11
10. Where things live p. 11
11. Terminology p. 12

1 How you'll ramp up

Each stage moves when you're ready.

Stage	Timing	What happens	Ready to move on when
Shadow	First few days	Watch invoices end to end, read the Invoicing Checklist, log questions	Can explain the invoice steps and the charge statuses
Drive with review	Once you're ready	Danny takes on backlog projects quickly given his experience, including 4821 Penn Station; Dax prepares what his time allows; Sam reviews each one	Invoices need few or no corrections
Own	After the review stage	Danny takes a defined project list; Sam spot-checks the first full cycle	Invoices go out on time with little rework

The big picture

We bill about 150 active clients, roughly 220 to 250 invoices a month, and NetSuite went live in July. Consultants work one month, timesheets are submitted, and invoices are produced early the next month.

Invoice type	Share	How it bills
Time and materials	Majority	Fixed hourly rate per employee; subs and expenses at cost or with markup
Lump sum / fixed fee	About 15-20%	Flat monthly fee; expenses billed separately
Percent of completion	About 2%	Very few projects

2 What we'll cover

This packet follows the same order. Timing is flexible, and topics can move earlier or later as long as they all get covered.

Start with

- Project lifecycle and who owns what
- Monthly billing cycle
- Three keys: project setup, invoice setup, charge review
- Charge statuses
- New project setup
- Rules and the matching Revenue Rule
- Steps of an invoice
- Pending Approval does not mean sent to the PM
- Delivery and Submitted Outside of NetSuite

Then

- Navigation and % search
- Checking time against charges and Non-Billable flags
- Invoice settings, charge review and WIP print
- Saved searches
- Walking through Francisco's new project (P5418, West Farms Bus Depot CNG)

Next

- Building rules for each billing type
- Add-ons: T&M, task splits, fixed fee, subs, expenses
- Choosing the right correction

Later

- Other project setup topics
- Retainage
- Invoice revisions and Credit Rebill
- Percent Complete projects
- Closeout and inactivation

3 Billing basics

Project lifecycle

P-Sale → Awarded → New project → Setup with the PM → Time, expenses, subs → Charges → Invoices → Client pays → Closeout

Most of our daily work sits in the middle: charges and invoices. But a problem on an invoice often started back in setup.

Who owns what

Owner	Work
Marketing	The P-Sale
Contracts and the PM	Project setup, task structure and resource assignments
Contracts	Billing rules, generating charges, labor transfers, preparing, reviewing and sending the invoice, and Credit Rebills
PM	Approving the invoice; starting closeout, which Contracts completes

Monthly billing cycle

Each month's hours get billed the following month, so in November we're billing October hours. Our target is to open billing on the 4th or 5th and close by about the 25th. Each of us keeps a tracker for our own invoices.

Three keys to a clean invoice

Most billing problems come from one of three places. When something looks wrong, check these.

Area	What to check
Project configuration	Resources, tasks, billing rules, rates, contract type, revenue rules. Allocating a resource to a task unlocks that task on the employee's timesheet.
Invoice configuration	Posting period, start and end dates, invoice number, bill-to address, notes and checkboxes
Charge review	The right people, hours, tasks, rates, expenses and subconsultants, with nothing missing or duplicated

Charge statuses

Status	Meaning
Ready	Can go on the next invoice
Hold	Won't appear until someone releases it
Processed	On a draft in progress or already invoiced
Non-Billable	Will never be invoiced

4 New project setup

Work through the project record top to bottom. The process also calls for a kickoff call with the PM to work through setup together.

> **Get the Customer right first.** Make sure the correct Customer is selected on the P-Sale when you copy it to a new billable project number, or update the Customer when you copy. The Customer cannot be changed once any transactions are booked against it, and it's very hard to fix after that.

When copying the P-Sale to a billable project

- [ ] Correct Customer selected
- [ ] Organization on the P-Sale double-checked
- [ ] Any remaining P-Sale fields completed
- [ ] Contract documents (usually received by email right now) added to the SharePoint file, or to the Communication tab on the project or tasks

Must be complete before billing

- [ ] Project Manager
- [ ] Invoicing Project Manager
- [ ] Resources
- [ ] Resource Details tab, with two Project Managers identified
- [ ] Project budget
- [ ] Task budgets
- [ ] Start and end dates
- [ ] Allow Expenses selected on the Preferences tab of the billable project

5 Rules

Rules put the correct charges on the invoice, and they're created at different times in a project's life. Some are added monthly. Some are added at the start of the project and updated once a year for rate increases. Fixed Fee projects need one or more new rules each month. **Every time a Project Rule is added, it needs a matching Revenue Rule:** select it on an existing Revenue Rule, or create or edit a Revenue Rule to include it.

Project record, section by section

Section	Fields to review
Primary Information	Project Biller, Project Manager, Invoicing Project Manager, Invoicing Project, Status, Project SharePoint Folder, Send Invoices from PM, Confidential checkboxes, Project Invoice Note
Invoice Printing Defaults	Withholding, Signed Timesheets, Billing Summary, Expense Attachments, Billing Back-Up
Contract Details	Contract Type, Contract #, Project PO #, Contract Term Date, Terms, Billing Contact, Project Billing Name, Original PMA Fee, PMA Current Fee, PMA Billing Limit, Pay When Paid Subcontractors
Retainage	Calculate Customer Retainage, Calculate Vendor Retainage, Retainage %, eligible item types, Prior Retainage Amount
Project Dates	Start Date, Estimated End Date
Email, Phone, Address	Project address and Project Attention
Project Segmentation	Organization, PMA Office, Primary and Additional Industries, Sector, Primary and Additional Services, Prime/Sub
Schedule tab	Tasks and subtasks, their dates, and Home/Field
Financial tab: Billing Information	Billing Type (always Charge-Based), Primary Currency
Financial tab: Expense Type	Apply to All Time Entries, Project Labor Type, Wage Type
Financial tab: Rules	Fixed Fee, Time-Based, Expense-Based, Purchase and Project Revenue Rules; Project Employee Parameter Override
Financial tab: Charges	Charges and Charge Run History
Other tabs to know	Resources, Related Records, Relationships, Preferences, Budget, P&L, Communication

6 How an invoice works

The seven steps

1. **Review charges** and adjust their status at the project level. Typically, what's on the project is what's on the invoice, aside from Additional Fees, Discounts and a few other exceptions.
2. **Raise the draft** from the Invoice Billable Customers page using the correct invoice dates.
3. **Review the invoice settings:** Invoice #, Posting Period, Invoice Dates and Billing Summary checkboxes.
4. **Review all the charges** on the invoice.
5. **Run the NS WIP Print** to see what the client will see.
6. **Submit** for PM approval.
7. **Deliver** to the client once approved, and record how it was delivered.

The Monthly Invoicing Checklist in the next section breaks these into detailed boxes to tick, grouped as Steps 1-6.

> **Pending Approval does not mean the PM has it.** NetSuite sets that status when a draft is first opened. Approval only starts when you click Submit for Approval.

Prep while it's in Pending Approval

The biller gathers documentation and timesheets, and processes subconsultant invoices. We run saved searches so PMs can see the hours or charges billed and assess the monthly fixed fee amount. We also prepare client spreadsheets, certified payroll and other client requirements.

Where a draft can be

A draft is either still being prepared by the biller, emailed to the PM, or submitted in NetSuite. Some PMs review by email because the package includes backup NetSuite can't include, or because they don't have a NetSuite license.

Delivery

Some clients get the invoice by email from NetSuite. Many need it by email with backup, through a portal, or in their own format. For those, select **Submitted Outside of NetSuite** once it's delivered.

7 Monthly Invoicing Checklist

Every invoice follows Steps 1–6 in order. In Step 4, do only the add-ons that match your project's billing type.

Step 1 Before you start

- [ ] Confirm the project is yours this cycle in the Contracts Billing Tracker, and set its status to In progress.
- [ ] If needed, open the project's SharePoint folder and read the client instructions: template, submission method, due date, required backup.
- [ ] Pull last month's invoice. Note anything carried forward (held hours, disputed items, client comments).
- [ ] Check the contract: billing type, rates, ceiling or task budgets remaining, retainage, and any new change orders or amendments.
- [ ] Collect any subconsultant invoices and timesheet backup for the period (if needed).

Step 2 Check time and expenses in NetSuite

- [ ] Compare the approved, billable time entries on the project for the billing period to the charges produced. If they don't match, something is missing — find it before you invoice.
- [ ] Look for entries wrongly flagged Non-Billable. Fix them before you build the invoice.
- [ ] Confirm each hour is on the correct task.
- [ ] Check the Manage Pending Charges page: every appropriate hour is in Hold or Ready status.
- [ ] Closed/Locked Period Time Changes: process coming. Bill older hours ASAP.
- [ ] Note any missed prior-period hours and how they will be billed.

Step 3 Project Rules and Revenue Rules

> **Rule:** If this month's invoice needs any change or addition to a Project Rule (Time-Based, Fixed Fee, or Purchase), it needs a matching Revenue Rule: select it on an existing Revenue Rule, or create or edit a Revenue Rule to include it.

- [ ] Confirm the existing Project Rules still match the contract (rates, fees, markups).
- [ ] Added or changed a Project Rule? Add it to the matching Revenue Rule.

Check: Before raising your draft invoice, check all charges at the project level and make sure they are all there (time, subs, expenses). With the correct parameters, they should be exactly what is produced when you raise the invoice.

Step 4 Build the invoice

All invoices, in order. Raise the draft as close to the approval date as possible, and submit the finalized package as close to the invoice date as possible:

- [ ] Go to Invoice Billable Customers and set the date range of hours to pull. Usually the first to last day of the month; some projects bill off-month.
- [ ] Once the invoice is raised and loaded, first update the Start Date and End Date fields again.
- [ ] Check Posting Period (Override) is correct for the current period you are billing in, then click Save. On first save, NetSuite pulls in the invoicing project and loads more project and customer fields.
- [ ] Update the invoice number if needed.
- [ ] Check all fields for accuracy and update the invoice formatting checkboxes. Fix anything you can quickly.
- [ ] Check Project Manager and Invoicing Project Manager are correct.
- [ ] Check charges: time, subconsultant invoices and expenses are all included. Add any additional fees or modifications.
- [ ] Tax applied where required (e.g., Puerto Rico), retainage applied if required, and total within the contract ceiling or task budget.
- [ ] Click NetSuite WIP Print Invoice to generate PMA's invoice PDF.

Then do the add-ons that apply

Time & Materials

- [ ] Hours × contract rate match the timesheet by person and labor category.
- [ ] Detailed timesheet backup attached if needed.

Multiple tasks on one invoice

- [ ] Hours released or held by task as instructed.
- [ ] Each task subtotal checked against its task budget.
- [ ] Summary by Task page matches the line detail.

Single-task invoices (one task per invoice)

- [ ] Only that task's hours released; all other tasks held.
- [ ] One invoice and number per task, each with its own backup.

Fixed Fee / Percent Complete

- [ ] Percent complete confirmed with the PM.
- [ ] Billed to date plus this invoice does not exceed 100% of the fee.

Subconsultants and markups

- [ ] Sub invoice received, matches the period, and is approved by the PM.
- [ ] Purchase rule picks it up at the correct markup.
- [ ] Sub invoice attached as backup.

Expenses

- [ ] Expenses are allowable under the contract and within any cap.
- [ ] Markup applied only if the contract allows.
- [ ] Receipts attached.

Step 5 Review and approval

- [ ] Self-check: open the invoice PDF and read it as the client will. Check totals, dates, names, page order, and that sub invoices and expense backup are included.
- [ ] Draft still Pending Approval while you finish it? When it is ready to submit to the PM, update the invoice date to the current date.
- [ ] Send to the PM for approval via NetSuite (and email if necessary).
- [ ] Email approval notification to biller once approved.
- [ ] Set the tracker status to Out for approval, then update it once approved.

Step 6 Submit and close out

- [ ] Package in the client's required format and template, with all backup in the right order.
- [ ] Submit by the client's method (email, portal such as e-Builder or PMWeb, or mail). Save the confirmation.
- [ ] Any prior-period or corrected hours are explained in the cover email.
- [ ] Save the final package and confirmation in the project's SharePoint folder.
- [ ] Set the tracker status to Billed.
- [ ] Log anything unusual (rule changes, held hours, client issues) in the project notes for next month.

8 Sample invoices

Process	Sample	What it teaches
Fixed Fee	04797.00	Lump sum billing, two tasks
Expenses	04886.00, October invoice	Shannon asked for split-period expenses to be held and included on the October invoice
Subconsultants	04749 GLWA	Sub invoices (METCO, Stantec, NTH) and the PM's write-up
T&M manual spreadsheet The client rejects penny differences, and NetSuite creates discrepancies (Deltek did too on this one).	04903.00 PI Consultants	Excel template, backup docs and matching the numbers to NetSuite. Early due date and date cutoffs.
Task by task	04547.00 United	Holding and releasing charges by task, one invoice at a time; Coupa submission

Tips for task-by-task billing (04547 United)

This project bills three invoices a month (A, B and C), at about 30 minutes each.

- In Manage Pending Charges, put all current-month hours on Hold, isolate the billing month's hours by task, and mark the correct ones Ready.
- The Case/Task/Event filter is available at the main list level, so you don't need to go into the project or invoice fields.
- Show Totals adds a sum row to the charges view.
- Before sending for approval, check the employee page under Time Tracking for pending or unapproved expense reports.

Client portal tip (Trimble). When submitting in Trimble, select PMA in the dropdown or the submission errors out.

9 Saved searches

We'll cover these in NetSuite after the first invoice walkthrough.

Search	Use it for
Saved Time Search - SZ	We'll go over this together
Actual Time Charges Samantha Results	We'll go over this together
Projects Missing Rev Rules	Finding projects with no Revenue Rule

10 Where things live

Item	Use it for	Where
Project Folder Structure	Filing invoices and contract documents	**SharePoint**
Monthly Invoicing Checklist	Step-by-step for each invoice	Section 7 of this packet
Contracts Billing Tracker	Project owners and this cycle's status	**Tracker**
Contracts Team Task Tracker	Blockers and NetSuite issues	**Smartsheet**
EUB: Unbilled Data Details	Unbilled hours from Deltek	**SharePoint**

11 Terminology

Billing terms

Term	Meaning
Billing Limit	The maximum amount that may be billed on a project, Task, or Subtask.
Charge	A billable transaction generated from approved project activity.
Credit Rebill	Creates reversing and replacement charges while maintaining invoice history. Used when the invoice was delivered and the billing period is closed.
Current Fee	The current total project budget.
Expense Rule	Billing rule used to invoice reimbursable project expenses.
Fixed Fee Rule	Billing rule used to invoice scheduled or recurring fixed fee amounts.
Hold	Charge will not appear on an invoice until manually released.
Home / Field	Resource designation used within billing rules.
Invoice Note	Customer-facing note that prints on the invoice.
Invoicing Project Manager	Additional Project Manager role used for invoicing-related management.
Non-Billable	Charge will never be invoiced.
NS WIP Print Invoice	The customer-facing view of a draft invoice, reviewed before submitting for approval.
Original Fee	The original awarded contract, task order, or work order amount.
Pending Approval	Status NetSuite sets when a draft is first opened. It does not mean the PM has the invoice.
Posting Period	Accounting period assigned to the invoice.
Processed	Charge on an in-progress draft invoice or already invoiced.
Project Manager	PMA's direct contact for contractual and project-related questions. Manages the project budget, tracks spend, and approves invoices.
Purchase Rule	Billing rule used to invoice subcontractor or vendor costs.
Ready	Charge is available to be billed on the next invoice.
Retainage	A portion of each invoice withheld by the customer until the project is complete.

Term	Meaning
Revenue Rule	Billing rule that controls project revenue recognition.
Submit for Approval	The action that starts the PM approval process.
Submitted Outside of NetSuite	Selected after delivering an invoice outside NetSuite, so the invoice history shows how the client received it.
Subproject	A child project commonly used for Percent Complete billing.
Subtask	Secondary work breakdown beneath a task.
Task	Primary work breakdown within a project.
Time-Based Rule	Billing rule used to invoice employee labor.
Write-Off	Removal of billable charges that will not be invoiced.

Acronyms

Acronym	Meaning
AP	Accounts Payable
AR	Accounts Receivable
CM	Credit Memo
NS	NetSuite
P-Sale	Promotional Project
PM	Project Manager
PO	Purchase Order
T&M	Time & Materials
WIP	Work In Progress